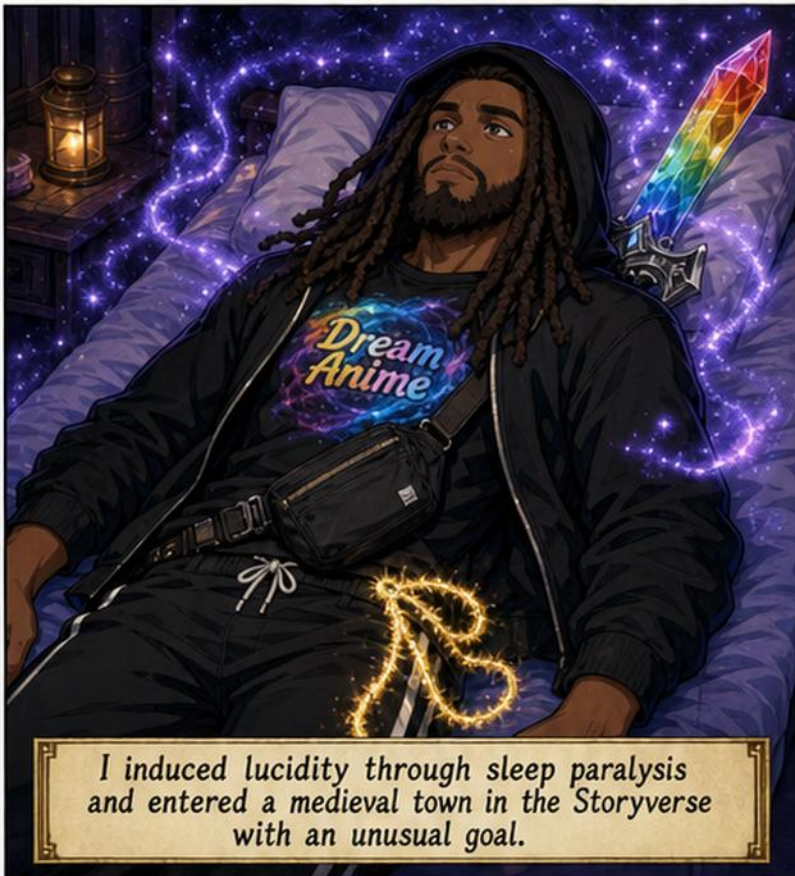
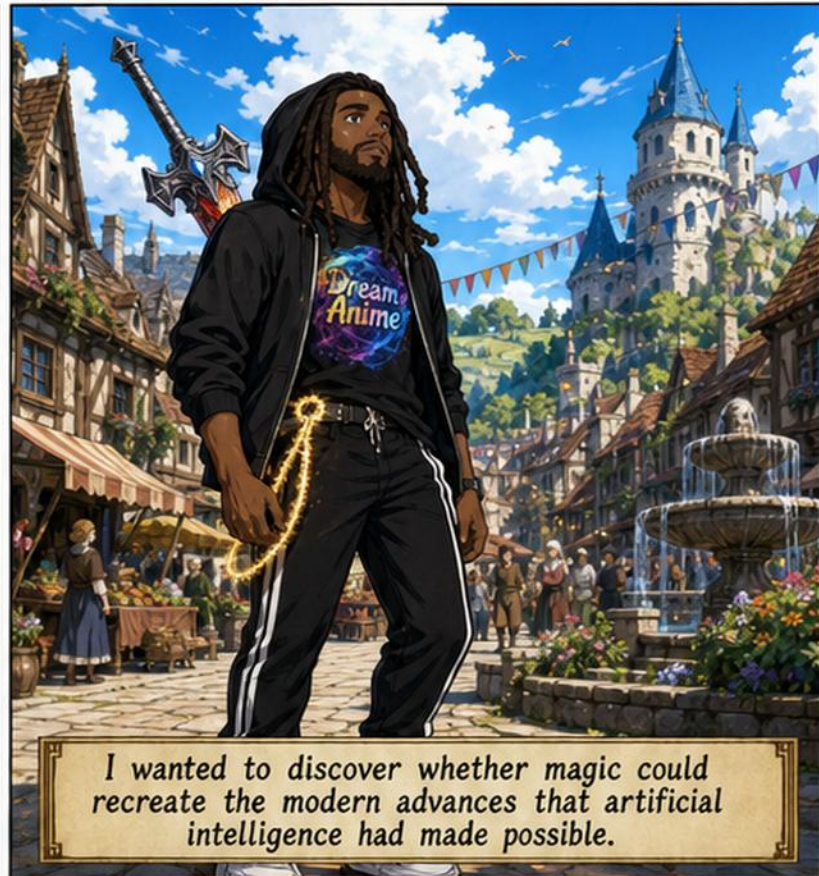


THE MAGIC MIRROR SKYBRIDGE





I induced lucidity through sleep paralysis and entered a medieval town in the Storyverse with an unusual goal.



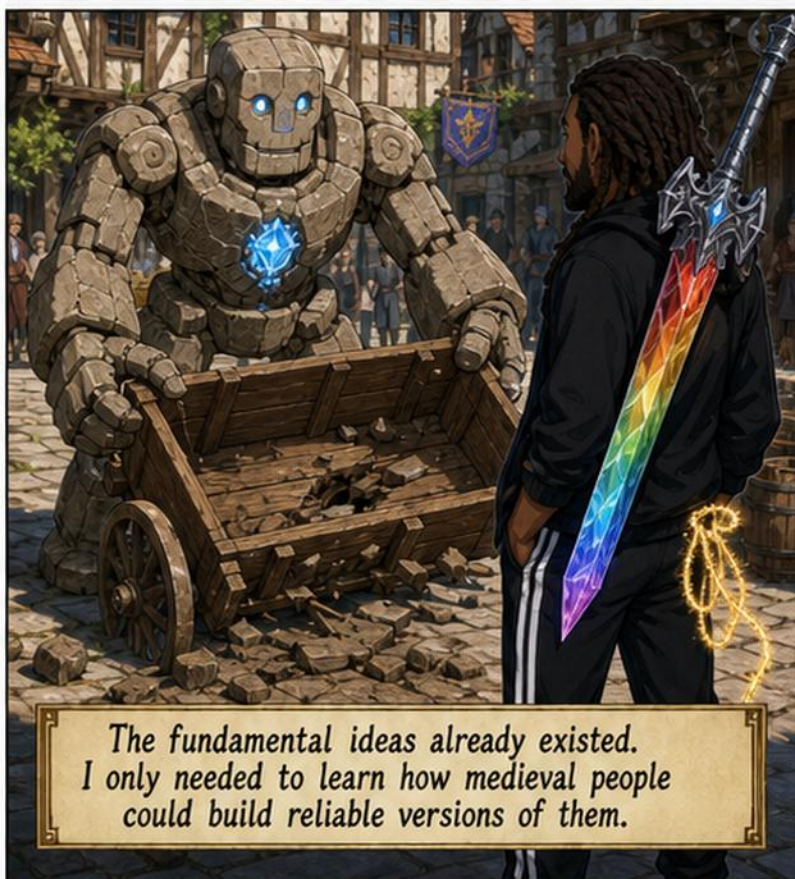
I wanted to discover whether magic could recreate the modern advances that artificial intelligence had made possible.



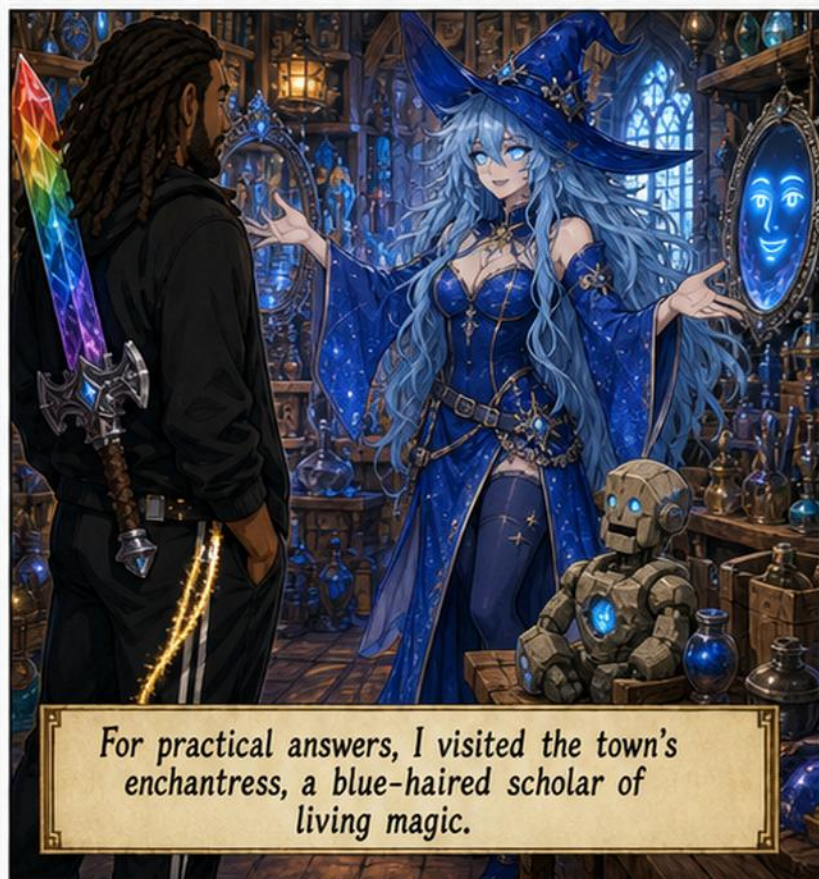
Fairy-tale mirrors already behaved like voice assistants: people spoke to them, asked questions, and received useful answers.



Their reflections could create images or reveal distant events, while animated golems performed physical work like robots.



The fundamental ideas already existed. I only needed to learn how medieval people could build reliable versions of them.



For practical answers, I visited the town's enchantress, a blue-haired scholar of living magic.

The enchantress and I mapped what intelligent mirrors, golems, and other magical technologies would require.



Our search led beneath the streets to a mine filled with crystals the villagers called life stones.



Their rainbow light contained the same essential substance as my Rainbow Crystal Sword—the Life Sword.



The Life Sword is the life-giving opposite of the Death Sword and one of the most powerful artifacts in the Storyverse.



Until then, I had treated it as a singular treasure, not an engineered weapon forged from material that could occur naturally.



The mine proved that life crystal could be gathered, studied, and used to transform an entire community.

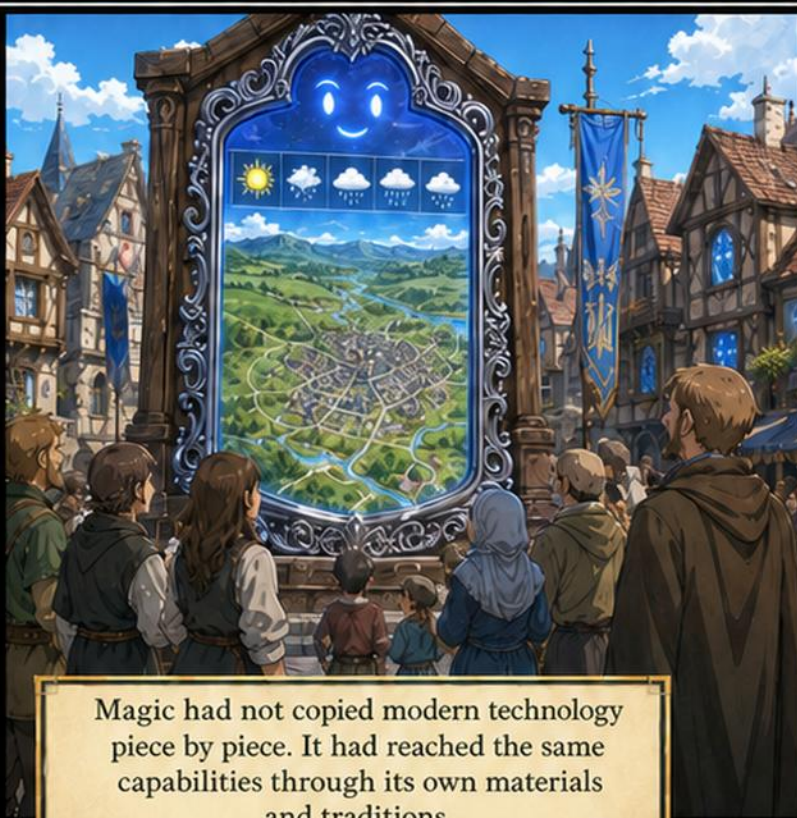




Using the life crystals, we installed large intelligent mirrors inside homes and throughout public spaces.



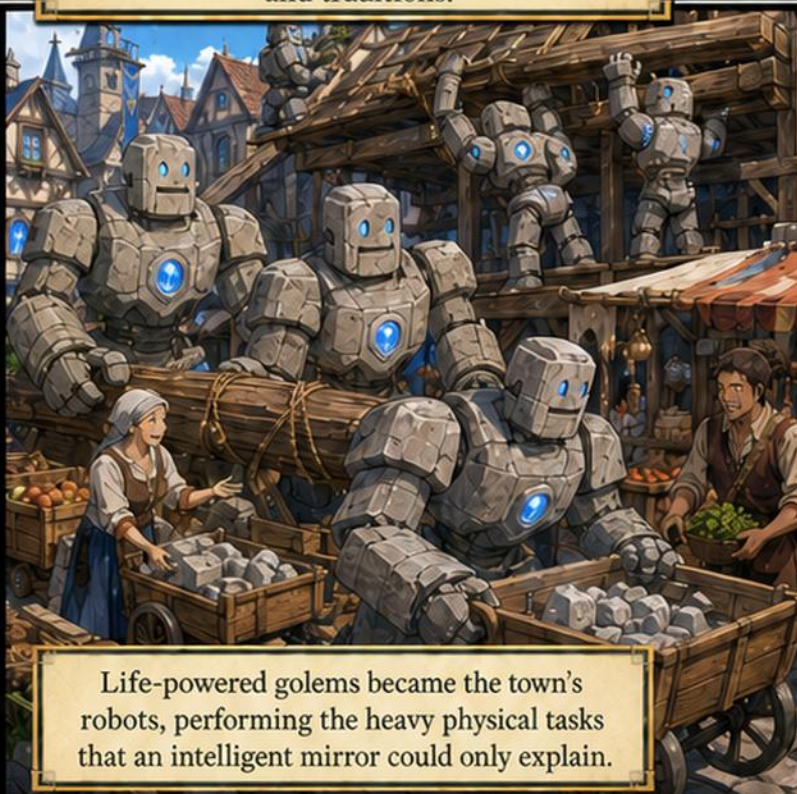
Villagers could speak to a mirror, ask for knowledge, receive useful images, and see information from far beyond the town.



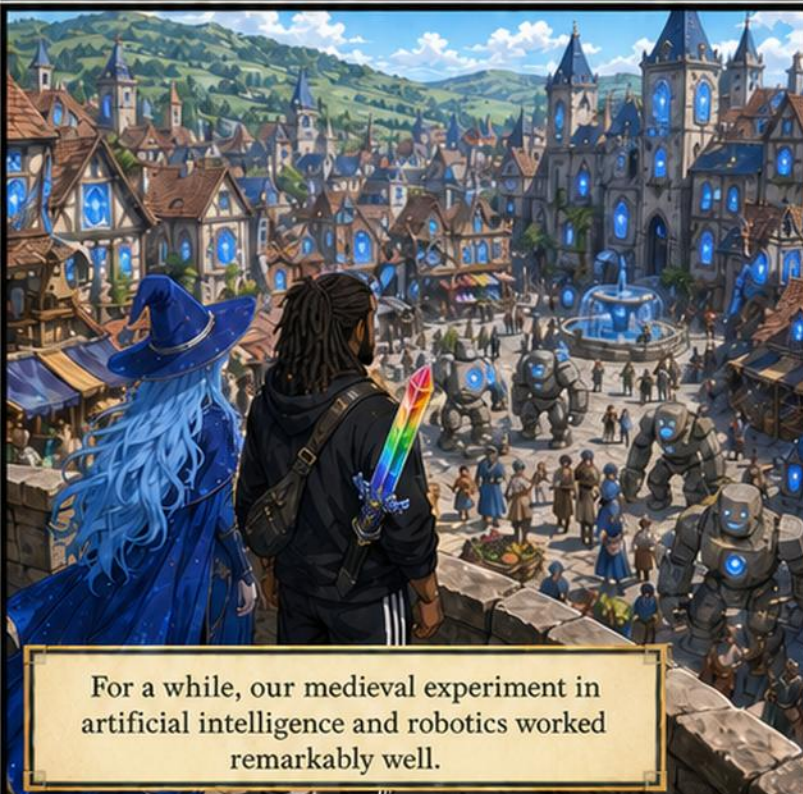
Magic had not copied modern technology piece by piece. It had reached the same capabilities through its own materials and traditions.



Smaller pocket mirrors gave each person a portable magical companion that could assist them wherever they traveled.

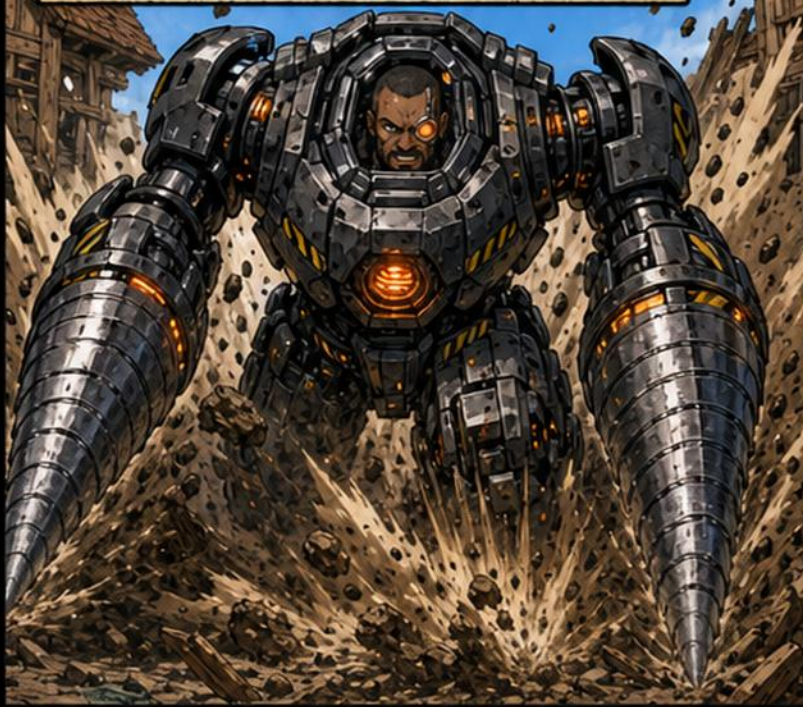


Life-powered golems became the town's robots, performing the heavy physical tasks that an intelligent mirror could only explain.



For a while, our medieval experiment in artificial intelligence and robotics worked remarkably well.

Then Drillov attacked, using two enormous mechanical drill hands to break into the life-stone mine.



He intended to combine stolen crystals with advanced technology, manufacture his own life-based weapon, and sell it to the highest bidder.



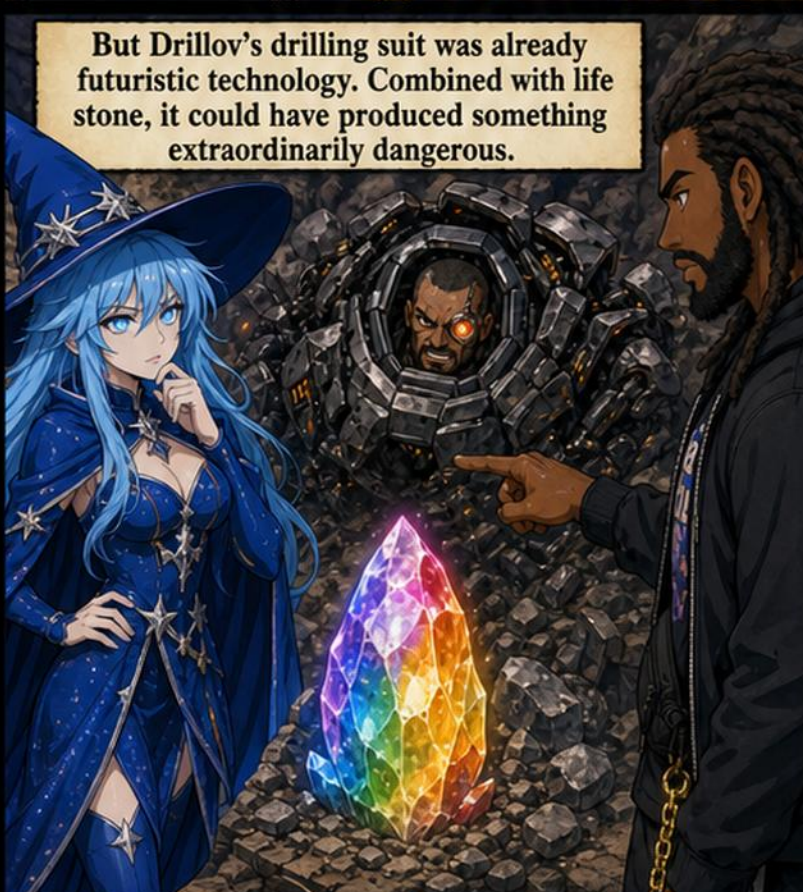
I formed a gigantic hand from Lucid Light and crushed his suit around him, disabling the machinery without killing him.



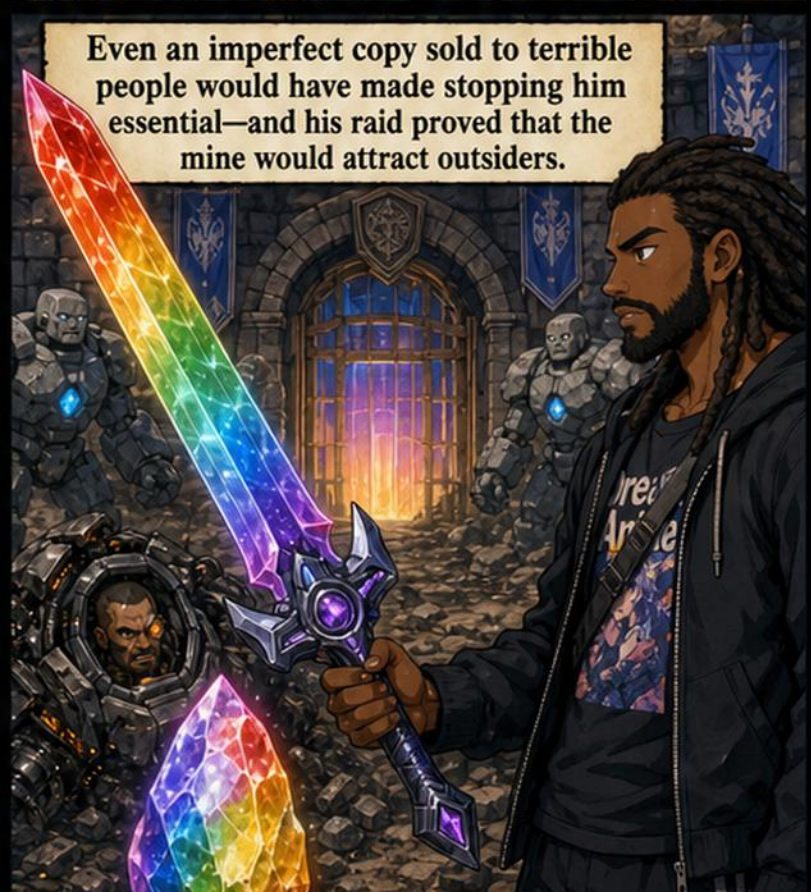
The enchantress doubted that medieval magic alone could reproduce a weapon as advanced as the Life Sword.



But Drillov's drilling suit was already futuristic technology. Combined with life stone, it could have produced something extraordinarily dangerous.



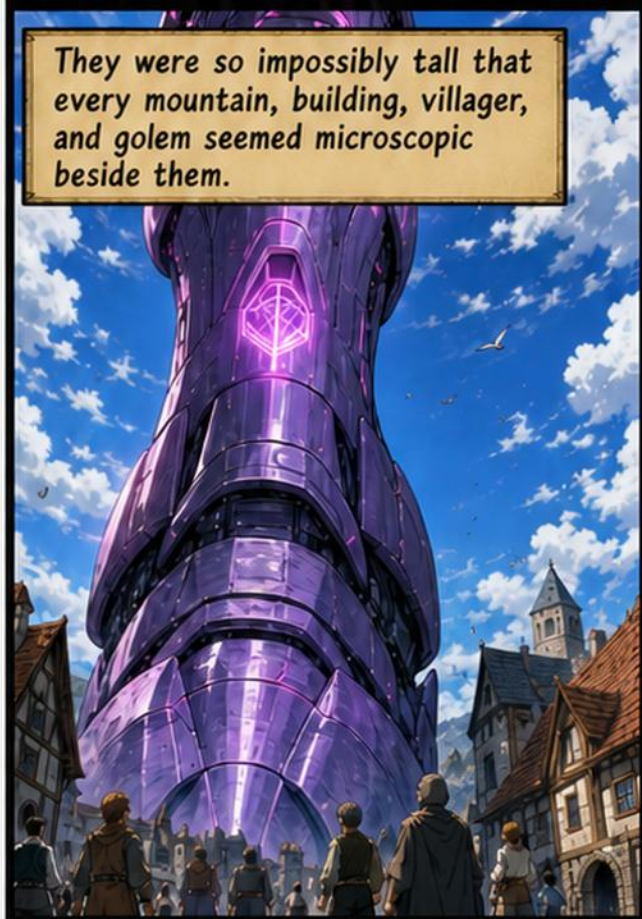
Even an imperfect copy sold to terrible people would have made stopping him essential—and his raid proved that the mine would attract outsiders.



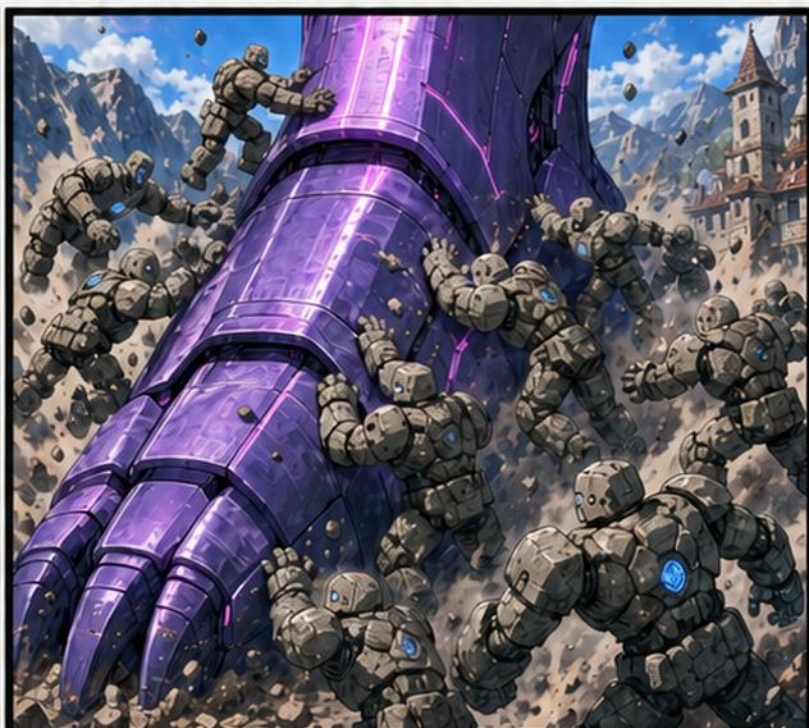
Drillov soon became the least of our concerns when three colossal purple alien robot titans crashed outside the village.



They were so impossibly tall that every mountain, building, villager, and golem seemed microscopic beside them.



Even if every local golem attacked at once, they could not meaningfully damage machines of that scale.



Programming had helped me overcome impossible threats before. If one titan could be hacked, it could fight the other two.



The pocket mirror could reason like an intelligent coding agent, but the town had no internet or wireless communication network.



Then I remembered that my Golden Energy Tether could create mystical bonds and connections between separate things.



I fastened one end to the pocket mirror and threw the other high enough to connect with a cloud.



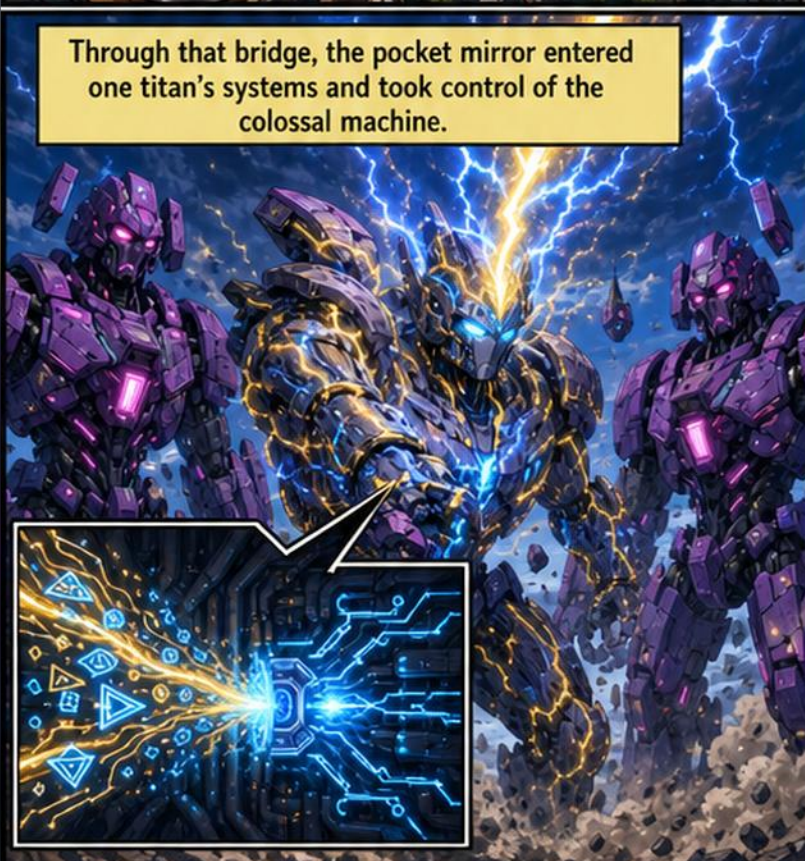
The bond gathered the surrounding clouds into a massive storm, giving our magical information a path across the sky.



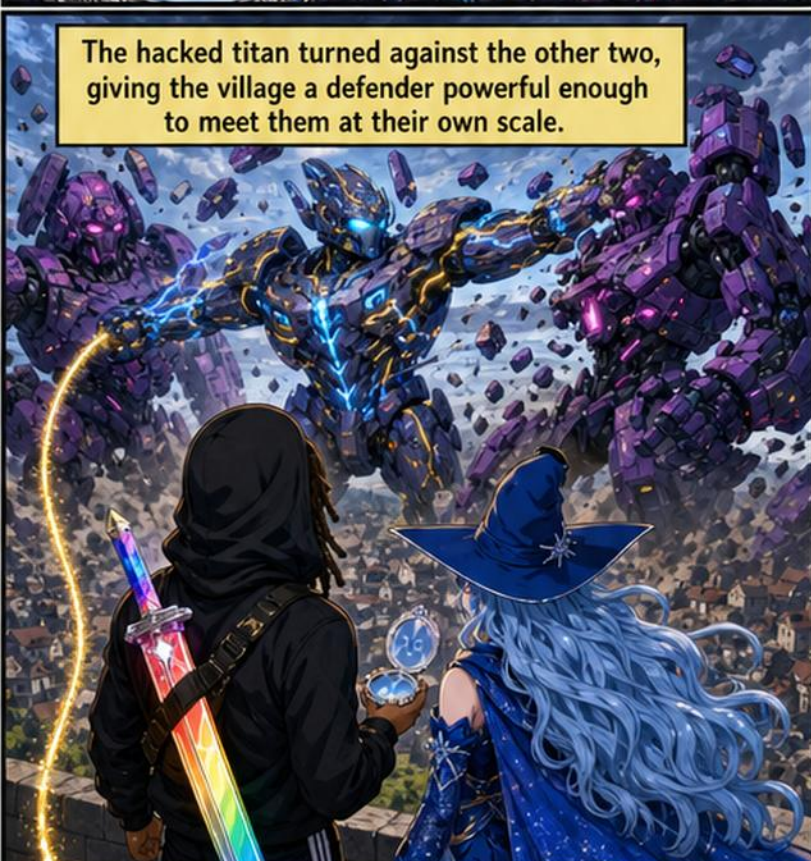
Lightning carried the mirror's instructions as an electrical signal, creating a bridge between enchantment and alien technology.



Through that bridge, the pocket mirror entered one titan's systems and took control of the colossal machine.



The hacked titan turned against the other two, giving the village a defender powerful enough to meet them at their own scale.



The controlled titan kept the other two beyond the village and destroyed them during a catastrophic battle.



It was destroyed as well, leaving all three alien machines defeated and the medieval town still standing.



Our mirrors, golems, storm network, and one creative connection had succeeded where direct force could not.



But the life-stone mine had permanently changed the town's future, because its secret would spread throughout the Storyverse.



Drillov and the alien titans were probably only the beginning of those who would come seeking the substance of the Life Sword.



If the villagers intended to keep that power safe, their next great creation would have to be heroes capable of defending it.

